LOW-CODE EXPERIMENT 11

Deploying a Zoho Creator Application from Development to Production Environment

Patient Appointment Booking System

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1. Aim

To understand the deployment process of a Zoho Creator application from the Development environment to Stage and then to Production, while identifying the role of each environment in a release workflow.

2. Concepts

Development: The environment where application forms, reports, pages, and workflows are created and tested.
Stage: A pre-release environment used to test the application with realistic scenarios before deployment to live users.
Production: The live environment used by end users. Changes should be tested before they are released here.
Deployment: The process of promoting the application structure from one environment to the next. Each environment can have its own data and application URL.

3. Requirements

• Zoho Creator account and the Patient Appointment Booking System application
• Existing patient registration form, reports, dashboard, and workflows
• Access to environment and deployment features, where supported by the account plan

4. Procedure

Step 1 — Prepare Development

Open the Patient Appointment Booking System in Zoho Creator. Review the Patient Registration form, All Patient Registrations report, Appointment Schedule Report, dashboard, and configured workflows. Test the form and its validation before deployment.

Step 2 — Verify the environment

Open the live application and check whether the interface or URL identifies the Development environment. Keep a record of the current working version before attempting a deployment.

Step 3 — Deploy to Stage

If the deployment feature is available, choose the option to deploy the application to Stage. Review the components included in the release, add a description such as “Release 1”, and confirm the deployment.

Step 4 — Test in Stage

Open the Stage application and test patient registration, required-field validation, appointment reports, dashboard figures, and workflow behaviour. Resolve any issues before promoting the application.

Step 5 — Deploy to Production

After successful Stage testing, use the available deployment option to promote the tested version to Production. Confirm the release and open the Production application to verify that the required components are available.

Step 6 — Maintain later releases

Make future changes in Development, test them, and repeat the Stage and Production deployment process. This helps keep the live application stable.

5. Application-Specific Notes

The Patient Appointment Booking System already contains a Patient Registration form, an All Patient Registrations report, an Appointment Schedule Report, a Patient Appointment Dashboard, an approval workflow, a consent-validation workflow, a reminder schedule, a blueprint, and a Deluge function. These components can be checked during Development testing and, if deployment is enabled, retested in Stage before release.

6. Execution Status and Limitation

The Development application and its existing components were available for review. In the current account interface, the deployment or environment controls for Stage and Production were not visible in the screens inspected. The lab manual provided for this experiment also notes that deployment to Stage and Production may require a paid plan. Therefore, those deployment steps are documented as the procedure but are not claimed as executed.

7. Expected Output

The same application structure—forms, reports, dashboard, and workflows—should be available in Stage and Production after a successful deployment. Each environment should be verified separately, and later Development changes should not affect Production until they are deployed.

8. Result

The Development-to-Stage-to-Production release flow of Zoho Creator was studied and documented for the Patient Appointment Booking System. Development components were reviewed, while Stage and Production deployment could not be confirmed in the current account and are recorded as pending due to unavailable deployment controls.

9. Learning Outcome

Learned the purpose of Development, Stage, and Production environments; the steps involved in promoting an application between environments; and the importance of testing a release before making it available to live users.